

RESEARCH PROPOSAL FORM

Student Details		
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Tutor: Prof. Salamah Mahmood	Evaluator:	
Proposed Research Title (Provisional)		
The Impact of Social Media on Saudi Children's Food Habits		
Research Questions (Please list your research questions. For example, they could investigate the problem, effects and solutions) Explain how they will help achieve the aim of your topic. Make sure that they can't already be answered with existing background information		
1. What are the effects of social media on Saudi Children food habits? 2. Why do children rely on social media about their food habits? 3. How can parents eliminate the negative effects of social media on their kids?		
Background Information (What information did you find related to your research area? Please provide a minimum of three references and explain how they support your choice of topic)		
(1) Guo (2023) conducted a systematic review and meta-analysis examining the impact of unhealthy food marketing on children through social media. The study found that exposure to such marketing increases children's preference for unhealthy foods and influences their eating behavior. This supports the current research by showing that social media plays a significant role in shaping children's food habits. (https://francispress.com/uploads/papers/mrD2Z6nsZjSlQ6XLttaHijJlqDfibXFLxfYqh2e.pdf) Smith et al. (2018) conducted a systematic review investigating the impact of digital food marketing on children and adolescents. The study found that exposure to food advertisements through social media platforms significantly increases children's preference for high-fat and high-sugar foods. The authors concluded that digital marketing techniques, including influencer promotions and targeted advertisements, have a measurable influence on unhealthy eating behaviors among young populations. (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6073489/pdf/ijerph-15-00963.pdf) (page2-3) Alanazi et al. (2023) conducted a systematic review examining the relationship between social media use and unhealthy dietary habits. The study found a significant association between high social media exposure and increased fast food consumption, particularly among younger populations. The findings suggest that digital content and online food promotion contribute to poor nutritional behaviors. (https://saudijournals.com/media/articles/SJMPS_912_839-844_FT.pdf) (1) Guo, M. (2023). <i>The impact of unhealthy food marketing on children on social media platforms</i>. <i>Frontiers of Society, Science and Technology</i>, Vol. 5 No. 15, pp. 58–62. Francis Academic Press.		

- (2) Smith, R., Kelly, B., Yeatman, H., & Boyland, E. (2018). *Digital food marketing to children and adolescents: A systematic review. International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, Vol. 15 No. 5, Article 963.
- (3) Alanazi, A. M. L., et al. (2023). *Impact of social media on fast food consumption and increased bad nutritional habits: A systematic review. Saudi Journal of Medical and Pharmaceutical Sciences*, Vol. 9 No. 12, pp. 839–844. Saudi Center for Science and Education.

Proposed Research Design & Strategy

(Provide details and information about your potential participants. Why are they relevant to your topic? What method of data collection would you consider using?)

The participants will be Saudi parents of children aged 8–15 years old who regularly use social media platforms. They will be asked about their children's social media usage and eating habits.

Parents were chosen because they influence and monitor their children's behavior, especially food choices and social media exposure.

Population: Saudi parents of children who use social media.

Sample: 50 Saudi parents of children aged 8–15 years old whose children regularly use social media.

A questionnaire will be used.

Tutor and Evaluator Comments